

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 30

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

This Bible teaching is a cornerstone concept of Karis Fellowships training. Perhaps you already know the parable of the sower. In this parable, Jesus teaches us that our souls are similar to the soil on which good seed falls. The quality of the soil determines the outcome of the seed. Seeds fall on the road, on rocky soil, on soil full of weeds, or on cultivated soil, and each type of soil will produce a different outcome. If you want to know the quality of the soil of a person's soul, just throw some seed out there and see what happens. Now let's look at Nancy's translation of **Mark 4:28–29**. This passage follows the parable of the sower.⁵

²⁶And He [Jesus] was saying, "In the same way the kingdom of God is like a man throwing seed onto the earth; ²⁷And he lays down to sleep and wakes up, night and day, and the seed sprouts and grows up in a way that he cannot see or understand. ²⁸The earth acting of its own will bears fruit—first the grass, then the ear, then the full grain in the ear. ²⁹And when the fruit yields up, immediately the farmer sends in the sickle because the harvest is at hand."

Take a deep breath.

In this passage, Jesus is teaching about the cycles of cause and effect in the kingdom of God. When you invest in the kingdom, you get more in return. You cannot always see or understand how this works, but you know that if you plant quality seed in the prepared soil of your life, you can expect quality results. Your business is to provide an environment that will accommodate, protect, and nourish the seed that you have planted. Just as you can prepare soil to nurture the potential of the seed, you can cultivate a life that will nurture the life-giving outcomes of your oriented choices. God has created a power within all seed that, given the right environment, makes things happen. Once you have prepared the soil of your life and planted your seed, you can rest while the soil does this mysterious thing called *produce*. When the harvest is ripe, you can confidently, without hesitation, reap what you have sown. By cooperating with God's way of doing things, you become the cause of your own abundance.

In the karis economy of the kingdom, the cycles of cause and effect operate at two different levels. This economy is built on trust, not law. Although Level 1 is the foundation that we must lay before we can progress to Level 2, our goal is to live at both levels concurrently. At the first level of the karis economy, the cause produces an effect that is fairly predictable, but at the second level, the effect cannot be predicted. Let's take a closer look at these two levels.

Level 1: Preparing the soil

At Level 1 of the karis economy we learn to give the gift of just trying to do things God's way. When you commit to living at this first level, you are choosing to do the following three things:

- 1. Obey kingdom law:** Learn God's kingdom law of orientation and obey it.
- 2. Cultivate more orientation:** Learn what orientation feels like and looks like, and mindfully act in ways that cultivate it.
- 3. Choose life:** Avoid misoriented behavior.

When you practice these things, you become a cause that produces a predictable effect. You prepare the soil of your life for a harvest of peace rather than anxiety, and stability rather than chaos. This level lays the foundation upon which you build your karis life in the kingdom of God. At Level 1, you begin to change the course of your outcomes.

Level 2: Planting the seed

The second level of the karis economy of cause and effect also involves three choices, but because the results of these choices cannot be predicted, this level requires greater depth of trustworthiness and faith. At this second level of karis, you have developed confidence in the power of your oriented, trustworthy life. You prepared the soil in Level 1, and now you actively and intentionally plant seeds by giving your true gifts—the gifts God designed you to give. Your gifts carry spiritual power that perpetuates your cycle of circulation with God and the Creation. Although you cannot predict how God will respond to your gifts, you trust that He will return to you only good and perfect gifts that will enrich your karis relationship with Him. You discover that His response is always immeasurably beyond all that you could ask for or imagine.

At Level 2, you show God that you are trustworthy by returning gifts to Him of these three things:

- 1. Love your neighbor as yourself:** Treat those very well who support you.
- 2. Do good to the trustworthy community:** Support members of the community who are investing in their true glory.
- 3. Act with kindness toward the world:** Offer gifts of care and support to those outside of the community.

The cause at this level of karis is your relationship with God. He invites, and you respond by offering the gift of becoming trustworthy. Your trustworthy choices invite Him into more relationship, and He responds with more gifts and invitations. The effect or outcome of this mutual generosity is unpredictable, but it will always be exactly what satisfies and fulfills.

In our passage from Mark, we see that the farmer does his part by giving something away. He faithfully throws his seed, and then he waits. He does not see or understand how the seed grows. That is what the second level of karis is like. We do oriented things, make oriented choices, and give without calculation or expectation. Marvelous things begin to happen, but we do not know how they happen. We cannot make direct correlations, nor can we predict how long it will take before we see the fruit. This is why karis requires trust—not trust in a certain predicted outcome, but trust in the Person of God.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Creator of the seasons, teach me how to plant that I might reap with joy. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for this time of training and healing. Hold us in the power of the cycle of karis as You guide us to our glory and to the truth about Your intentions for us. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and design, with our community and the rest of Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.